



Living together



The CLEAN-

Every day millions of plants and animals die. Considering that organisms have been living and dying for billions of years, why are we not standing on a thick layer of dead

SCAVENGERS

Scavengers are animals that prefer to hunt for dead animals, or carrion, rather than catch live prey, although most carnivores will also eat dead meat. Scavengers rely on their acute sense of smell to find a carcass, sometimes from far away. They have sharp teeth or beaks and strong jaws that can rip a body open and crack bones. By breaking open the carcass they also make it easier for smaller scavengers, such as insects and crows, to nip in and grab a bite.



EARTHWORM

Plant scavengers

Not all scavengers eat animals. Earthworms pull fallen leaves into the soil and termites send out search parties to bring plant material back to their nest. The cellulose in plant cell walls is a rich source of energy but is indigestible to many animals. Plant scavengers break it down and excrete what they can't use into the soil.

GARDEN
SNAIL

Leaves are
YUMMY!

Sharp sight

Good for spying carcasses from high in the sky.

Vultures are *supremely adapted* for scavenging.

Bald head

No feathers to get covered in blood and guts.

Long neck

Useful for dipping deep inside a carcass.

Digestive juices

Strong enough to kill bacteria in rotting meat.

Sharp talons

For getting a grip on a carcass to tear it apart.



GRIFFON
VULTURE